LAND WHOLESALING BUSINESS PLAN

How Carson and Jackson — Brothers Who Started at 19 and 21 With No Real Estate License, No Degree, and No Money — Built a Virtual Land Wholesaling Business Across 25–30 States, Did $100,000+ Every Month for 40 Straight Months, Hit $532,000 Profit in a Single Month, Closed 239 Deals in Their Best Year for $1.7 Million in Profit, and Can Do It All From a Public Library With a Flip Phone and a Zillow Account

Based on the Koerner Office Podcast Episode with Carson and Jackson, Founders of carsonjackson.com

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Executive Summary

Carson and Jackson are brothers. Carson was 19 and Jackson was 21 when they started wholesaling land. They had no real estate license, no college degree, and no money. They did not know what they were doing at the beginning. They figured it out deal by deal. Four years and a few months later, they have done $6 million in profit, hit $100,000+ per month for 40 consecutive months, closed 239 deals in their best year for $1.7 million in profit, and had a single month where they made $532,000 in assignments. They have done deals in 25 to 30 states, all virtually — they have never seen the lots they sell.

The business model: find a home builder who needs land. Get their buy box — the price they will pay, the lot size they want, the zip codes they buy in. Then go find land owners in those zip codes who will sell for 10 to 20% less than the builder will pay. Get those sellers to sign an assignable contract. Send both contracts to a title company. Two to three weeks later, collect a wire for the difference. No money down. No real estate license required in most states. Average profit per deal: approximately $8,600 at 90 to 95% margins.

Key numbers from the episode: Ages when started: 19 (Carson) and 21 (Jackson). States active in: 25–30 (can do in approximately 44 states; roughly 6 states have restrictions). Average profit per deal: ~$8,600. Gross margin: 90–95%. Monthly revenue range (current): $100,000–$300,000. $100K+ months streak: 40 consecutive months. Best single month: 37 deals, $532,000 in profit. Best year: 239 deals, $2.1 million in assignments, $1.7 million in profit. Total profit in 4 years: over $6 million. Biggest single deal: over $200,000 profit. Notable large deals: $191,000; $165,000; $110,000; multiple at $85,000+. Pending deal at time of recording: 22-lot package in Arizona worth $468,000 over 2 years or $330,000 in 30 days. A student who bought a $1 million listed lot sold it to a builder for $1.11 million in 30 days for a $110,000 profit. Free starter: no money needed; Zillow, True People Search, ChatGPT for contracts, your phone. SMS campaign scale (at peak): 50,000 texts/month at ~$1,200/month; 37x return on investment. Direct mail scale (at peak): 40,000 mailers/month; made slightly more total than SMS even at slightly lower ROI. VA cold callers (at peak): 9 callers overseas making thousands of dials per day. Jackson's personal cold call discipline: 100 cold calls per day for 3 years = ~100,000 calls. Earnest money risk: essentially zero (feasibility clause allows exit until closing date; builders deposit their own earnest money on assignment contracts). Deal timeline: typically 2–3 weeks; fastest: 72 hours. Referral program: handwritten thank-you letter after every close; $1,000 cash for a referred deal; 28–29 referral deals in their best year. Neighbor call: True People Search by address; call next-door neighbors as potential buyers who pay above market. Two requirements for a market: (1) more than 5 newly built homes in the zip code; (2) all lots are similar in size (cookie cutter). States avoided or limited: Texas (mass texting laws); fully built-out major metros. Hot markets named: Florida (Cape Coral, Lehigh Acres, Bonita Springs, Southwest Florida), North Carolina (Wilmington), South Carolina, Georgia, Nevada, *Washington, Hawaii, Arkansas (Bentonville, northwest). Non-disclosure state limitation: Texas does not show sold prices on Zillow; can work around by looking at listed prices instead. Biggest builder relationship: DR Horton (largest US home builder); builds ~25,000–30,000 scattered lots per year in 212 divisions. Team at scale: 2 acquisition managers, 1 transaction coordinator, VAs in Philippines (up to 20+ cold callers at peak; average ~5). Software: Buyer Bridge (their own CRM; 12,000 buyers, 6,000 buy boxes; V2 launching soon); Land Portal; PropStream; Kind Skip Tracing; Reply Smart / Smarter Contact (SMS); REI Print Mail (direct mail); ReadyMode / Batch Dialer (dialer software). Website: carsonjackson.com.*

PART 01 — What Is Land Wholesaling? The Business Model in 90 Seconds

The Core Mechanic

Land wholesaling is the practice of securing a contract to buy a piece of land at one price, then selling the right to purchase that land to another buyer at a higher price, and keeping the difference. You never buy the land yourself. You put it under contract with an assignable clause, find a buyer who will pay more, and assign the contract to them. The title company handles both transactions simultaneously. You collect the spread.

Carson and Jackson's version is slightly more structured than generic wholesaling: they find the buyer first (a home builder), get the price the builder will pay, and then go shopping for land at a lower price. They call this the builder-first method. Instead of finding a deal and then hunting for a buyer, they know exactly what the buyer wants and how much they will pay before they ever contact a single seller.

Step	Who Does What	Tool or Method	Time
1. Find a builder	Identify a spec home builder actively constructing homes in a target area	Zillow: filter by homes built in 2025 or 2026, for sale; see builder name and contact on listing	30 minutes to a few hours per market
2. Get the buy box	Call the builder; ask what they pay per lot, what lot sizes, what zip codes	Phone call; builder tells you exactly what they want	5–15 minute call

3. Pull a seller list	Get names and addresses of landowners in those zip codes who have owned land cheaply for a long time	Land Portal or PropStream (paid); Zillow (free); True People Search for phone numbers	1–2 hours to build a list
4. Make offers	Contact sellers via direct mail, cold call, or text; offer 10–20% less than the builder will pay	REI Print Mail (direct mail); Smarter Contact / Reply Smart (SMS); cold calls	Days to weeks of outreach
5. Get an assignable contract signed	When a seller agrees, send them an assignable contract at the agreed price	Buyer Bridge; title company; contract generated via ChatGPT (free)	Same day to a few days
6. Notify the builder	Send the contract to the builder; builder reviews within hours	Email; Buyer Bridge CRM	2 hours typical response
7. Assignment and close	Builder deposits earnest money; title company coordinates closing; you collect the spread	Title company; wire transfer	2–3 weeks typical; 72 hours minimum

PART 02 — Why Land, Not Houses: The Structural Advantages

The Drop-Shipping Analogy

Carson compared land wholesaling not to house wholesaling but to drop shipping: you find someone who will pay $20 for a t-shirt, you get it for $10, you keep the $10 in the middle. The land business works the same way but with dramatically fewer variables than house wholesaling. A quarter-acre lot in Florida with no trees and no flood zone is essentially identical to the quarter-acre lot three doors down with the same conditions. There are no extra bedrooms, no pool, no 20-year-old roof, no foundation issues, no tenant who needs to be evicted.

Variable	House Wholesaling	Land Wholesaling

Comparable properties	Complex: bedroom count, bathrooms, age, condition, updates, layout, school district, nearby nuisances	Simple: lot size, flood zone status, wetlands coverage, utilities availability, slope — all checkable online or from aerial view
Seller relationship	Long rapport-building required; average call is 20–30 minutes; emotional attachment to the home	Short: 90–120 seconds typical; offering money, not taking something; no emotional attachment to vacant land
Buyer type	Fix-and-flip investors; cash-strapped; buying 2–4 houses per year; unpredictable	Home builders; multi-billion dollar companies; buying 30 lots per year from one builder; repeat business; reliable and professional
Repeat business	One and done: you sell a house; someone lives there; you cannot sell them another	Rinse and repeat: sell 10–20 deals per month to the same builder; builders text you every morning asking for more lots
Deal secrecy risk	House buyer and house seller can meet at the property, compare notes, cut you out	Lot buyer (builder) and lot seller (landowner) have no reason to connect; transaction is clean
Local knowledge required	High: school districts, neighborhood stigma, specific micro-markets, hidden defects visible only in person	Low: all key variables (flood zone, wetlands, utilities, slope, wildlife) are checkable online; you never visit the property
Profit margins	Variable; often 5–15% before transaction costs	90–95% margins at scale; few write-offs; minimal overhead

The Buyer Quality Difference

Carson's strongest argument for land over houses: who you are selling to. When wholesaling houses, your buyer is typically a local fix-and-flip investor who is buying two to four houses per year and is cash-strapped by the capital they have committed to current projects. They might back out. They might negotiate you down. They might meet the seller at the house and cut you out. When wholesaling land to DR Horton or another major home builder, you are dealing with a multi-billion dollar company that buys 25,000 to 30,000 lots per year across 212 divisions. They are not going to risk the relationship with you over one deal. They text you every morning asking for more lots.

PART 03 — The Builder-First Method: Start With the Buyer

The Original Error

Carson and Jackson started by finding deals first and then looking for builders to buy them. This is the standard wholesaling sequence — find a deal, then find a buyer. The problem: you do not know what price to offer sellers until you know what buyers will pay. Carson described the evolution: they switched to builder first — reach out to the builder first, get their exact price, then go shopping for land 10% below that. If the builder will pay $50,000, find it at $40,000 and you already know you have a buyer before you contact a single seller. One email and the deal is done.

The Ethical Dimension

The builder-first method also solves an ethical problem with traditional wholesaling: lowballing sellers without knowing whether any buyer will actually pay what you think they will pay. Carson was explicit: they take a transparent approach. They tell sellers they are working with builders, that they plan to pass the property to a builder within four to six weeks, and that they plan to make 8 to 10% between. They guarantee the seller the price they agree on. The seller gets certainty of closing in three weeks with no realtor fees or closing costs. That transparency, Carson argued, is actually better for the seller in many cases than listing with a realtor who will take 8 to 10% in commissions, take six months to sell, and likely accept 90% of asking price anyway.

The transparent pitch to sellers: 'I work with 20 to 30 builders throughout this area. I am going to get this property. We are going to clear the trees, make sure there is no wildlife, potentially get surveys, and pass this off to my builder within four to six weeks. I look to make 8 to 10% in between. I am transparent about that. If I guarantee you $40,000, you are going to walk with your $40,000 that we agreed upon.' The seller avoids realtor fees (8–10% on vacant land), avoids months of waiting, and gets certainty of close. In many markets, the net proceeds are similar to or better than a traditional sale.

PART 04 — How to Find Builders for Free on Zillow

The Zillow Filter

The free method to find spec home builders in any market: go to Zillow, filter by homes for sale, set built year to 2025 or 2026 (or current year). Any home built in the current year that is listed for sale is a spec home — built by a builder to resell, not a custom home someone built for themselves. The builder's name and phone number are typically listed directly on the Zillow listing. Call them.

Zillow Filter Setting	What to Enter	Why
Property type	Houses for sale	Looking for newly built homes, not lots (yet)
Year built	2025 or 2026 (current year)	Homes built this year and listed for sale are almost certainly spec homes — someone is building to sell
Sort by	Newest first	Find the most active builders first; also identifies active markets
On listing page	Read listing agent/builder name; look for contact information	Builder's name and phone are often on the listing; they are easy to call directly

The First Call to a Builder

Carson described what a builder call looks like: 'Hey, I see you built seven homes in the past month. I see you've paid about $50 to $60,000 for all of them. The lowest listing on the market that you would pay on the MLS is $60,000. What would you pay if I brought you a deal right now off market?' From this call, you get the buy box: what price, what lot size, what zip codes. That is all you need to start.

Two Requirements for a Market

Carson stated the two non-negotiable criteria for a market to work with the land wholesaling model: (1) More than five newly built homes in the zip code — this confirms there are active spec builders buying land. (2) All lots in the area are similar in size — cookie cutter. If lots are 9 acres in one place and 1 acre next door, you cannot send mass offers because each property needs its own price. You need a market where every lot is approximately the same so you can send one blanket offer to every owner at once.

PART 05 — What Is a Buy Box and How to Get One

The Definition

A buy box is the specific set of criteria a builder uses to decide whether to purchase a lot: the price they will pay, the lot sizes they want, and the zip codes or neighborhoods they buy in. Once you have a builder's buy box, every seller you contact is either a fit or not a fit — there is no guessing. You know before you make a single offer whether the deal you are about to pitch has a guaranteed buyer.

Buy Box Element	What to Ask the Builder	Example Answer
Price	What will you pay for a lot in this area?	I will pay $50,000 for any quarter-acre lot in this zip code
Lot size	What lot sizes do you buy?	Quarter-acre to half-acre; nothing smaller; nothing rural
Zip codes / neighborhoods	Where exactly are you buying?	Zip codes 33909, 33917, and 33971 in Cape Coral and Lehigh Acres, Florida
Volume	How many lots are you looking to buy?	I buy 3 lots per month; I could absorb 8–10 if you bring them
Condition requirements	Any specific conditions? Utilities? No slope? No wetlands?	Must be buildable; no wetlands; utilities to the street or well-septic acceptable; no protected wildlife
Timeline to close	How fast do you need to close?	I can close in 30 days; faster if the title work is clean

Managing Multiple Builder Relationships

Carson and Jackson work with builders ranging from DR Horton (the largest home builder in the US, doing 25,000–30,000 scattered lots per year across 212 divisions) to single-build operators who do one or two homes per year. Having multiple builders in any market gives flexibility: if one builder passes on a deal because of a slope or a specific condition issue, another builder might take it. Carson also described a dynamic they discovered: once you bring enough deals to a builder, you develop enough leverage to push back on their offered price. When Carson had exhausted a campaign area and could no longer find lots at the builder's original price, he told the builder: I cannot bring you deals at $40,000 anymore. If you bump to $42,500, I can go back. The builder said yes.

PART 06 — How to Find Sellers: Lists, Mail, Text, and Cold Calls

The Seller Profile

The ideal seller for land wholesaling is an out-of-state landowner who bought the property cheaply more than five years ago, has not built on it, and is now paying property taxes that have risen significantly as land values went up. They are not actively trying to sell because they think they are holding an asset, but they are quietly motivated because the property tax burden is real and growing. Carson described a common scenario: a lot someone bought for $8,000 is now worth $100,000. When it was worth $8,000 they paid $13/month in property tax. Now they are paying $2,000/year for land they have never visited and never intend to build on.

Seller Type	Motivation Level	Best Outreach Method	Notes
Out-of-state owner; bought cheap 5+ years ago; paying growing property tax	High — they want liquidity; taxes are rising; they are not building	Direct mail (highest quality response); cold call (fast)	Most reliable seller type; typically no realtor; equity-rich; motivated by taxes and convenience
Owner who got land via inheritance	Medium-high — sentimental attachment but no personal use	Direct mail; cold call; personalized approach important	Need to establish trust; often unaware of current value; can be very motivated once they understand their options

Owner with multiple lots	High — if they will do one they will often do a package	Same channels; check linked properties in PropStream	Package deals are extremely profitable; same seller, multiple transactions
Owner who listed on Zillow; listing expired	Very high — they tried to sell and failed	Call immediately when listing expires	Already validated motivation; just failed on price or process; your speed and certainty are compelling
Adjacent lot owner (neighbor)	Variable but often above-market motivated	True People Search by property address; call directly	They will pay above market because the lot extends their property; always call the neighbor before closing with a builder

Outreach Channels and ROI

At peak scale, Carson and Jackson were sending 50,000 texts per month ($1,200/month; 37x ROI) and 40,000 direct mail pieces per month ($20,000–$30,000/month; slightly higher total revenue but lower ROI than SMS). For beginners, they recommend starting with cold calls — free, teaches the process, and forces you to learn what sellers actually say and how to respond. At 100 calls per day, that is 36,500 offers per year. If you get 10 people to say yes, that is over $100,000 in profit.

PART 07 — The Mass Offer Direct Mail System

The Concept

Carson described a direct mail approach that was responsible for some of their most unexpected deal flow: they would pull a list of lot owners in a target zip code, send each owner a one-page introduction letter plus a pre-filled contract with their cash offer already on it. The letter explained who they were, what they do, and that they were offering to buy the property at the stated price with a three-week close. No phone call required. Some sellers would simply sign the contract and mail it back. When they lived in Miami, they would check their mailbox every other day and find signed contracts — closed deals from people they had never spoken to.

Direct Mail Component	What It Contains	Purpose
Introduction letter (page 1)	Who you are; your company; how many builders you work with; your website; that you specialize in land in their area; testimonials if available	Build credibility; establish legitimacy; explain the value proposition
Pre-filled contract (page 2+)	Seller name and address; property address and description; your cash offer price; closing timeline (21–30 days); assignable clause; feasibility contingency; signature line	Make it as easy as possible to say yes; no negotiation required; seller just signs and returns
Return envelope or instructions	Self-addressed envelope OR instructions to email or call	Remove all friction from the response process
Offer price	Builder's price minus your spread (10–20%)	The offer must be below market but compelling enough that motivated sellers say yes without negotiating

Outreach Method	Cost to Send	Volume at Peak	Approx ROI	Best Use Case
Cold calls (yourself)	$0	100/day; 36,500/year	Highest — zero cost; teaches the process	Starting out; first 6–12 months; never stop calling inbound leads yourself
Direct mail (letter + contract)	~$0.50–$1 per piece	40,000/month at peak	High total revenue; slightly lower ROI than SMS	Best quality responses; signed contracts sometimes arrive unsigned-directly; works in all states
SMS / text campaigns	~$0.024/text ($1,200 for 50K)	50,000 texts/month at peak	37x ROI all-time; ~$44K–$45K/month from SMS alone	Very high volume; restricted in Texas; must comply with TCPA; use platforms like Reply Smart or Smarter Contact

Ringless voicemail	Low	Variable	Lower than SMS or mail	Less effective; feels impersonal; not recommended as primary channel
Neighbor calls (True People Search)	$0	Every deal: 2–3 calls	Above-market deals; neighbors pay premium	Always call neighbors before closing with a builder; can result in higher-profit deal

The Mail Math

At peak scale: 40,000 mailers per month at approximately $20,000–$30,000. Total revenue from mail historically was slightly more than SMS revenue even though the ROI was slightly lower, because the absolute spend was much higher. For a beginner, the minimum viable version: find a list of 50 owners who paid below current market more than five years ago, find their mailing address through county records or PropStream, write a one-page letter and mail a contract. Cost: stamps and paper. Results: Carson and Jackson's Miami mailbox story confirms this works even at small scale.

PART 08 — The Cold Call Script

The Mindset Shift

Carson made an important point about cold calling land sellers versus house sellers: you are not really selling anything. You are offering to give someone money. The conversation is fundamentally different from cold calling to sell a product or service. The seller is almost never offended by the call. The only question is whether your offer number works for them. If it does not, the call ends politely and you save their number for when they are ready. Carson's longest calls are 90 to 120 seconds. Jackson has signed contracts in under 5 minutes from the first touch point.

The Basic Cold Call Structure

Carson walked through a sample call live during the interview. The structure: open by confirming you have the right person and the right property, make the offer, briefly explain the value versus a traditional sale, handle one counter-offer, and if they are not ready to sign, save the number.

Sample cold call script (Carson's live example): 'Hey Chris, is this the owner of 123 Main Street? Awesome. I was reaching out — would any chance would you be open to selling this property if I came in at the right price? [They respond.] What we're going to do here is come with a full cash offer. You're going to avoid all realtor fees. You're not going to pay any closing costs. So what I offer you is going to be net cash to you. What I can do is close two to three weeks right now and get you a contract today at $28,000 plus all closing costs. [They say: the one around the corner sold for 38.] Awesome. So if I were to be able to do what that one sold for, is that something you would be interested in? [They say yes.] Well, that property actually did get listed in January and closed six months later. I know it said it closed at $38,000, but with land they pay 8% to agents and about $1,500 in closing costs. You are really walking with $33,000 to $34,000. I am going to be very transparent — I work with a ton of builders in the area. I have someone ready to go. I have a builder that will pay $35,000 plus closing costs. So what I can give you is $33,500. That is the same you would have gotten from that other sale but instead of six months, it will be done in three weeks. [Deal is done.]'

Cold Call Element	What to Say	Why It Works
Opening	Hey [name], is this the owner of [address]?	Confirms you have the right person; personalizes the call; shows you did your research
Initial ask	Would you be open to selling this property if I came in at the right price?	Soft ask; no pressure; lets them respond before you give a number
The offer	I can give you $X plus all closing costs. We can close in 2–3 weeks.	Net cash to seller (they pay nothing); specific timeline; removes uncertainty
The competitor comparison	That sale took 6 months; after realtor fees and closing costs, they netted $33K. I am offering $33.5K in 3 weeks.	Math the comparison; seller sees the practical reality that your offer is comparable or better after costs
If they decline	All right, no worries. Save my number as Jackson Land Guy. If you ever need to sell, that is where I am at. Have a good day.	Plants the seed for future calls; many deals come from sellers who said no six months before
The counter-offer move	If they say can you do $17K? Say let me run into my partner's office and check. Wait 90 seconds. Come back: yes, we can do that.	Never say yes immediately — creates the perception that you fought for them; reduces buyer remorse; higher closing rate than instant yes

PART 09 — Contracts: The Assignable Contract and Earnest Money Protection

The Assignable Clause

Every contract Carson and Jackson use has two critical elements: an assignability clause and a feasibility contingency. The assignability clause allows them to sell the contract to another buyer (the builder) without the original seller's further involvement. Without this clause, they would need to actually purchase the property themselves to resell it. With it, they simply assign their rights under the contract to the builder for a fee.

The Feasibility Contingency

The feasibility contingency is their protection against deals that fall through. The contract gives them a feasibility study period up until the closing date, during which they can exit the contract for any reason with no penalty. When a builder passes on the property for any reason, Carson and Jackson simply send a termination email and walk away. They have never lost an earnest money deposit in four years of operation.

The Earnest Money Flow

Carson and Jackson's approach: their earnest money obligation to the seller is $250 (or whatever the seller asks for), and it is not actually due until the closing date — not at signing. On the builder's assignment contract, they require the builder to deposit earnest money. This means the builder's money is funding the seller's earnest money obligation. If the deal falls through because the builder decides not to proceed within the first 2 hours of review, Carson and Jackson simply terminate and owe nothing.

Contract Element	How It Works	Protects You From
Assignable clause	Gives you the right to sell your interest in the contract to another buyer	Having to buy the property yourself; being locked into a deal with no buyer

Feasibility contingency	Right to exit the contract for any reason until closing date with no penalty	Wildlife discoveries; wetlands reports; slope issues; builder passing; any deal-killing condition
Earnest money timing	EMD not due until closing date (not at signing); $250 typical if required	Losing money if you discover a problem and need to exit before closing
Builder's earnest money	Builder deposits their own EMD on the assignment contract; funds seller's deposit	You having to put up your own capital to secure the deal
Deal timeline	Typical 2–3 week close; builder responds within 2 hours whether they are taking the deal	Waiting 30 days to find out a builder passed; having capital tied up in uncertain deals

Getting a Contract for Free

For beginners with no money: ask ChatGPT to write an assignable vacant land purchase contract legal in all 50 states. Review it. Send it through a free contract service. Carson confirmed this works and described two students who did exactly this: one made $5,200 in their first 14 days; another completed three deals for $9,500 in assignments — all without even having an LLC set up yet.

PART 10 — What Can Kill a Deal: Wetlands, Wildlife, Slope, and Utilities

The Key Variables

Carson was clear: land has far fewer deal-killing variables than houses. Most issues are discoverable from aerial photos, county records, or a simple phone call to the city. And because of the feasibility contingency, a deal-killing discovery just means sending a termination email — no financial loss. He estimated that approximately 5% of properties have a material issue.

Issue	How to Spot It	Impact on Value	What to Do

Wetlands	Aerial view on Zillow: gray trees indicate standing water and dead trees from flooding; green trees are fine	Massive: a lot that is 40% wetlands sold for $165K where 100% clean would have been $600K; one lot next door that was 100% wetlands was worthless	Commission a wetlands report before closing; factor into offer; if builder rejects, exit under feasibility clause
Gopher tortoises (Florida)	Cannot spot from aerial; requires on-site survey; $6,000–$8,000 per turtle to relocate; protected under Florida law	Deal killer for most builders; they will not build where protected tortoises nest	Ask builder upfront what wildlife kills deals in their state; order wildlife survey before committing to builder
Scrub jays (Florida/other states)	Protected bird; varies by region; calls to the city reveal protected species in an area	Can prevent building entirely in affected zones	Call the city: 'What wildlife protections apply to this address?' Simple and free
Slope	Aerial view shows topography; county GIS maps show elevation data; builders will tell you their slope tolerance (e.g., no more than 10-foot setback)	Can reduce value by 80%+ in markets like Arkansas where slope affects buildability significantly	Ask builder their slope tolerance in advance; check county GIS before making offers
No utilities / well and septic required	County assessor records show utility connections; builders prefer city water and sewer	Without utilities, lot is worth less; well-septic lots still buildable but at lower value	Check county appraiser website; note utility status in your offer and pitch to builder accordingly
Seawall present	Visible on aerial for waterfront lots; county records confirm	Adds $20,000–$30,000 to value; positive factor	Mention to builder; adjust offer upward accordingly to capture more of the value
Main road location	Visible on any map; builders and home buyers avoid main road lots	Significant negative: builders avoid it because buyers do not want to live on a highway	Avoid making offers on main road lots or price them very conservatively
Flood zone	FEMA flood maps; visible on Zillow and most county GIS tools	High flood zone designation reduces demand; increases insurance costs	Check flood zone before offer; use as negotiating factor

When to Learn New Issues

Carson acknowledged they continue to learn new issues in each new market. Scrub jays. Slope setbacks in Arkansas. Well depths in North Carolina. The pattern: when they enter a new market, something unexpected comes up. They call the city, ask what it means, and learn. This is part of the business — there is no substitute for experience, but the experience compounds quickly and the exit mechanism (feasibility clause) means learning by doing is relatively low-risk.

PART 11 — The Numbers: $8,600 Average Profit, 90–95% Margins, 40 Months Straight

The Core Economics

Carson stated the key metrics explicitly: average deal profit is approximately $8,600. Gross margins are 90 to 95%. They have done $100,000+ per month for 40 consecutive months. Their best month was 37 deals for $532,000 in profit. Their best year was 239 deals, $2.1 million in assignments, $1.7 million in net profit. Total profit in four years: over $6 million.

Metric	Value	Notes
Average profit per deal	~$8,600	All deals blended; ranges from a few thousand to $200,000+
Gross margin	90–95%	Very few costs: no inventory, no materials, minimal overhead; main costs are marketing and team
Monthly revenue (current)	$100,000–$300,000	Lumpy month to month; big deals skew individual months; look quarterly for true picture
$100K+ months streak	40 consecutive months	Including periods with deal delays, market changes, and scaling challenges
Best single month	$532,000 in profit from 37 deals	Combination of base hit deals and several large deals closing in the same month

Best year	239 deals; $2.1M assignments; $1.7M profit	Almost one deal per business day; 255 business days in the year
Total profit in 4 years	$6+ million	Reported by Carson on the podcast; profit, not revenue
Largest single deals	Two over $200K; $191K; $165K; $110K; multiple at $85K	Land deals can be very large — lots worth $750K–$1M+ create large spreads
Marketing spend at scale	$1,200/month SMS (50K texts); $20K–$30K/month direct mail	Not required to start; free methods exist and have produced deals
SMS ROI	37x all-time	50,000 texts/month returning ~$44,000–$45,000/month in profit from that channel alone
Tax burden (the downside)	High — 90–95% margin means almost all profit is taxable; few write-offs	Carson identified this as the biggest downside when starting out; work with a tax professional

The Lumpy Revenue Problem

Carson was candid: do not evaluate this business month by month. Deals close when they close. A $190,000 deal that was supposed to close in May might push to June 1st. Now June looks like a $400,000 month and July looks like $100,000. The underlying business is stronger in July than June suggests, but the numbers do not reflect it. He recommends looking at the business quarterly. The 40-month streak is the signal — not any individual month.

PART 12 — The Team: What Roles to Hire and When

Start Alone; Scale Slowly

Both Carson and Jackson explicitly recommended doing everything yourself in the beginning. Their reasoning: you learn the nuances, you hear what sellers say, you develop instincts about which leads are worth pursuing and which are not. If you hire a VA in India to make your first calls, the accent may reduce response rates, and you will miss all the patterns and objections that only become visible if you are the one having the conversations. Carson made 100 cold calls per day for three years. That is where his knowledge came from.

Role	What They Do	When to Hire	Where to Find Them
Acquisition manager (2 at scale)	Call sellers; agree on price; send email to get the deal to the transaction coordinator	After you have done enough deals yourself to know exactly what a good deal looks and sounds like; can train someone because you know the process	Philippines via Upwork or online jobs.ph; US-based as you scale; hire for attitude first
Transaction coordinator (1)	Send contracts to sellers; manage title work; keep sellers happy during the close; coordinate with title companies across multiple states; call every seller weekly	When you are doing more than 10 deals per month and the logistics are consuming your time	Executive assistant with real estate transaction experience; can be US or Philippines
Cold callers / VAs (5 on average; up to 20 at peak)	Make thousands of dials per day; identify interested sellers; transfer warm leads to acquisition managers	Early on, as soon as you have a buy box and a working script; but do it yourself first to know what good looks like	Philippines via Upwork or online jobs.ph; mass Zoom interviews of 50 people at once; hire for attitude and friendliness, not just experience
Executive assistant (for referral program)	Handwrite thank-you letters to closed sellers; manage $1,000 referral check program	When you are doing enough volume that personalized follow-up is slipping through the cracks	Part-time remote; Philippines or US

The Philippines VA Advantage

Carson described their VA hiring process: mass Zoom interviews of 50 people at once. Brief format — 20 minutes total. Each person says their name, their experience, and a quick story about themselves. In 20 minutes of back-to-back quick introductions, you get a clear read on who is naturally friendly and articulate. The primary filter is attitude, not technical skill or experience. Carson found that in the Philippines, a talented VA may have lost their last role because their employer's company shut down, not because of poor performance. This creates a talent pool of experienced, motivated callers who are available at lower cost and are known for loyalty when treated with respect.

PART 13 — The Tech Stack: Buyer Bridge, Land Portal, PropStream, and Skip Tracing

The Tool Progression

Carson and Jackson ran pen and paper and a whiteboard for the first phase of their business. They cold called themselves for years. They started this with nothing but a phone and an internet connection. The tech stack they use now is for running a high-volume operation doing hundreds of deals per year. A beginner does not need any of it.

Tool	What It Does	Cost Level	Required to Start?
Zillow (free)	Find builders (filter by homes built this year for sale); find on-market lots; find neighbors to call	Free	Yes — this is your primary research tool at zero cost
True People Search (free)	Enter any address; get the owner's name and phone number; free skip tracing at low volume	Free	Yes — use this for individual lookups when you are starting
ChatGPT (free)	Generate an assignable contract for vacant land legal in all 50 states; generate offer scripts; research markets	Free	Yes — contract generation is possible at no cost
Buyer Bridge (their own software; paid)	Full CRM for land flipping; manages 12,000 buyers and 6,000 buy boxes; title work; contracts; partner network	Paid; V2 launching at time of episode	No — use it when you have volume that justifies a dedicated CRM
Land Portal / PropStream (paid)	Pull lists of landowners by zip code; filter by ownership duration, purchase price, and other criteria	Paid subscription	No at start — True People Search and Zillow suffice; essential at scale

Kind Skip Tracing (paid)	Get phone numbers in bulk for a list of landowner names and addresses	Paid per record	No at start; essential for mass campaigns
Reply Smart / Smarter Contact (paid)	Send bulk SMS campaigns to landowner lists	Paid per message	No — start with cold calls; add SMS when you have budget and legal clarity
REI Print Mail (paid)	Send direct mail at scale; handles legality questions; mails contracts and letters	Paid per piece	No — can mail yourself at small scale; outsource when volume justifies
Ready Mode / Batch Dialer (paid)	Multi-line dialer for cold calling VAs at high volume	Paid subscription	No — individual cold calls from your phone are sufficient to start

PART 14 — The Referral Program and Neighbor Strategy

The $1,000 Referral Program

After every closed deal, Carson and Jackson have their executive assistant handwrite a thank-you letter to the seller. The letter says: if you refer a family member or friend to sell their property and we get a deal done, we will send you $1,000 cash. In their best year, they completed 28 to 29 deals from referrals alone. At an average profit of $8,600 per deal, those referral deals generated approximately $240,000 to $250,000 in profit. The $1,000 referral fee cost roughly $29,000 to acquire that revenue — a customer acquisition cost of about 12%.

Most people are stingy with referral fees. They offer $50 Amazon gift cards. But if your average deal profit is $8,600, a $1,000 referral fee is $7,600 in free money that would not exist without the referral. The $1,000 is meaningful enough for the seller to mention it to their family and friends. It comes out of the deal proceeds — you never actually paid it from your own pocket. It is just a fraction of money that would not have existed without the referral.

The Neighbor Call Strategy

Before Carson closes any deal with a builder, he calls the neighboring property owners. The method: use True People Search with the neighboring address to get the neighbor's phone number. Then call them: 'Hey, I just want to give you the courtesy call. I am planning on selling the lot right next door to you to a home builder. If you have any interest in extending your yard, adding a pool back there, or purchasing this lot for any reason, I wanted to give you the first look before it goes to the builder.'

Neighbors consistently pay above market because the lot has specific value to them that no other buyer can replicate. The host confirmed this from personal experience — he paid $470,000 for a one-acre lot behind his property when the market said $400,000 maximum, because he wanted to own the entire strip of land and create a private road connecting two roads. No other buyer would have paid that. Neighbors create exactly that dynamic for Carson and Jackson on every deal.

Post-Close Action	What to Do	Revenue Generated	Cost
Handwritten thank-you letter	Executive assistant writes personal thank-you to seller; includes $1,000 referral offer if they refer another seller	28–29 referral deals in their best year; ~$240K–$250K in profit	~$29,000 in referral fees; time of EA
Neighbor call before closing	Call adjacent property owners via True People Search; offer first right of refusal at market or above	Significant — neighbors pay above market; deal closed with neighbor means no builder fee required	Phone call; 5–10 minutes per neighbor
Linked property check	Check PropStream or Land Portal for other lots owned by the same seller; they often own multiple	Multiple deals from one seller relationship; packages of 2–27 lots described in the episode	Included in existing software subscription
Save every phone number	Tell every cold call prospect to save your name as 'Jackson Land Guy'; follow up when they call back	Many deals come months or years after the original no; sellers call back when circumstances change	Zero — just follow-through discipline

PART 15 — 30-Day Launch Plan

Week 1: Market Selection and Builder Outreach

Day 1–2: Choose your market

Go to Zillow. Filter homes for sale. Set the built year to the current year. Pick a suburban market near a major city — not the major city itself (Miami is built out; 45 minutes from Miami is where the deals are). Look for neighborhoods where new construction homes are listed for sale. Zoom in on a zip code where you see at least five homes built this year for sale. These are your spec homes. That neighborhood has active spec builders buying land. Note the zip code and look at what lots in that zip code look like — are they all similar sizes? If yes, you have found a viable market.

Day 3–5: Get your first buy box

Pick two or three builders whose names appear on the new construction listings in your zip code. Their phone number is often listed directly on the Zillow listing. Call them. The script: 'Hey, I see you built several homes in the past month in this area. Are you looking for more lots? I bring off-market deals to builders. What would you pay for a lot in this neighborhood and what size are you looking for?' Get the price, lot size, and zip codes. Write these down in a Google Sheet. This is your buy box. You now know exactly what to pay sellers.

Week 2: Find Sellers and Make Offers

Day 6–10: Build your seller list

Go to Zillow and look at vacant lots listed for sale in your target zip code. For each lot, look up the address on True People Search to get the owner's phone number. Alternatively, look for lots that have been sitting on Zillow for more than 90 days without selling — these sellers are motivated. Start with 20 to 30 addresses. You can also ask ChatGPT: 'How do I find the tax records for landowners in [county, state] who have owned their lots for more than five years?' Most counties have free online property search tools where you can look up land by subdivision or street.

Day 11–14: Make your first cold calls

Call each person on your list. Use the cold call structure from Part 08. Open by confirming the address. Ask if they are open to selling. Make an offer at 10 to 15% below your builder's price. If they say no, ask if you can save your number as [your name] Land Guy and they can call you if they ever decide to sell. Track every call in a Google Sheet: name, address, phone, date called, response, offer made, status. If you make 30 calls per day for this week, you will have had approximately 120 conversations by the end of Day 14. You may not have a deal yet. That is normal. You are learning what sellers say, how to respond, and what your market's attitude toward your price is.

Week 3: Get a Contract Signed

Day 15–18: Get your assignable contract

Ask ChatGPT: 'Write me an assignable vacant land purchase and sale agreement that is legal in all 50 states. The buyer is [your name or LLC]. It should include an assignability clause and a feasibility contingency that allows the buyer to exit for any reason until the closing date. Earnest money of $250 is not due until the closing date.' Review it. Have a local real estate attorney review it if you want additional confidence. Alternatively, use Carson and Jackson's software (buyerbridge.com or carsonjackson.com) which may include contract templates. The key clauses: assignable, feasibility contingency, earnest money due at closing not at signing.

Day 19–21: Send the contract and notify the builder

When a seller agrees to your price, email or mail them the pre-filled contract the same day. Confirm receipt. As soon as the contract is signed, email your builder: 'I have a lot under contract at [address] for $X. It is [size] in [zip code]. Let me know within 24 hours if you want it.' The builder will respond within 2 hours in most cases. If they want it, send them the assignment contract. If they pass, send a termination to the seller and move on.

Week 4: Close and Get Paid

Day 22–28: Title company coordination

Once your builder confirms they want the deal, send both contracts (your seller contract and your assignment contract with the builder) to a title company in the state where the property is located. The title company will coordinate the closing. You do not need to be present. They will manage the paperwork, confirm the funding, and wire you the difference when the transaction closes. Typical close: 2 to 3 weeks from when you got the contract signed. Your wire for the difference arrives automatically. Follow up with your seller and builder every few days to make sure the title company has everything they need.

Day 29–30: Post-close systems

After your first close: send a handwritten thank-you letter to the seller mentioning the $1,000 referral program. Call the neighbors of every lot you sold to offer them first right of refusal on future deals. Check PropStream or county records to see if the seller owns any other lots — they often do. Add the builder to your relationship list and ask them: 'Now that we have worked together, what other markets or areas are you buying in? I can bring you more deals.' You have now done the hardest part. The second deal is easier than the first. The tenth is easier than the second.

Closing: From a Public Library With a Flip Phone

Carson and Jackson's closing thought: if they went bankrupt today, fired their team, and lost everything, they could walk into a public library with a flip phone, pull up Zillow for free, and be making $20,000 per month wholesaling land in Lehigh Acres, Florida within a month. No money. No employees. No software. Just Zillow, True People Search, a phone, and the knowledge of how the business works.

That is the test of a real skill versus a business that depends on specific resources or systems. The skill is knowing how to identify a builder's buy box, find sellers at a lower price, structure an assignable contract, and close the transaction in two to three weeks. That skill has nothing to do with software. It cannot be taken away. It is in your head.

In Lehigh Acres specifically at the time of the interview: thousands of off-market lots available, 99 sales in the last 90 days, probably thousands more that year. Carson and Jackson have done over 300 deals there. A market of that size in that condition can support multiple people making $20,000 per month from a library with a flip phone.

Jackson made 100 cold calls per day for three years. Not 100 dials — 100 conversations with people who own land. That is 109,500 conversations over three years. From those conversations came the pattern recognition that let him identify motivated sellers in 30 seconds, close contracts in 5 minutes from first contact, and negotiate with builders who are trying to push prices down. There was no magic website. There was no shortcut. There was just doing the unscalable, unsexy thing — picking up the phone and dialing a seven-digit number — over and over again until he was an expert.

Carson and Jackson's final word: educate yourself first. Know what to offer before you start. Understand what a good market looks like. Have a builder lined up. Have your contracts ready. Then make as many offers as possible. You cannot fail if you do not quit.

-- The Koerner Office

Sources: All revenue figures, deal counts, and business practices sourced exclusively from the Koerner Office podcast episode with Carson and Jackson. The brothers are not attorneys. Consult legal and financial professionals before engaging in real estate transactions. SMS texting laws vary by state and change frequently.